

Hello Song

Try this simple song at the start of your music lessons.

Key points

- It is in a swing style so the quavers are swung - think “Scoo-by, doo-by” rather than equal “jog-ging, jog-ging”.
- The song features the ‘So-Mi’ minor 3rd interval and uses a range of a 5th.
- The verse section introduces the concept of ‘Call and Response’ and each child has the chance to be the caller whilst the rest of the class respond. It will also help to internalise feeling 4 beats in a bar so that the children learn where to ‘place’ where to say their names.

Start by teaching your class the Chorus section of the song. ‘Copy me’ / ‘My turn, your turn’ works best.

Lyrics

**Hi, hello, how do you do?
It’s so nice to meet you.**

You could ask your class if they know any other ways to say hello?

If English is not a student’s first language, how do they say hello at home? Can they teach this to the rest of the class?

How many different ways to say hello does your class know?

If you have any students that are non verbal encourage them to use actions to engage with the song e.g. waving hello rather than singing hello.

If pupils use BSL could they teach the rest of the class how to sign hello?

- Once your class feels confident with singing the Chorus section move on to the Verse. Again use ‘Copy me’ / ‘My turn, your turn’ to teach the melody.

Lyrics

**Join in with the game.
Can you say your name?**

At this point in the song your students can take it in turns to introduce themselves and say their name for the rest of the class to repeat back. There is space for 6 children each cycle although some children may be hesitant and so there are several repetitions on the backing track to make allowance for this. Again this could be a physical action for the class to copy back if someone is non verbal or very shy about speaking in class.

Extension activities

- Can your students add an action to go with saying their name?
- Could they say their name in a creative way e.g. St, St, St, Stevie or vary the pitch or rhythm (put the stresses in different places) of their name?
- Use the Verse section to lead copy me actions e.g. tap your head / shoulders / knees 4 times for the children to copy back. Can the children improvise their own body percussion patterns during the verse section? Ask for volunteers to be the leader.